Solo Supper

Five dinners for one. One shop. *Nothing in the bin.*

Cooking for one, the waste is rarely the recipe: it's the rest of the pack. These five dinners are planned so that what Monday opens, a later night finishes: the beef mince and the tin of chopped tomatoes both get finished. Shop once at the weekend, then cook.

MONDAY



Cuban-Style Picadillo Beef Hash

23 min · Cuba

Opens the beef mince and tin of chopped tomatoes

TUESDAY



Egyptian-Style Koshari Bowl

30 min · Egypt

Uses up the tin of chopped tomatoes

WEDNESDAY



Speedy Cottage Pie Mash Cup

32 min · UK

Uses up the beef mince

THURSDAY



Spanish Tortilla-Style Potato & Onion Omelette

23 min · Spain

FRIDAY



Chilean-Style Beef & Corn Bowl (Pastel-Inspired)

26 min · Chile

Uses up the beef mince

Shop once

Page two is the list for all five dinners, added up, so two half lemons become one lemon.

Cook in order

The days matter: each dinner leaves something for a later one. Swap days if you like, but keep the order.

Bin nothing

At the end of the week you'll have some chopped tomatoes left over, and that's it.

THE SHOPPING LIST

One shop for all five

Everything for the week, added up. The small grey days show which dinners use each thing.

MEAT & FISH

- [ ] Beef mince — 480 g
  Mon, Wed, Fri

FRESH PRODUCE

- [ ] Onions — 3
  Mon, Tue, Wed, Thu, Fri
- [ ] Garlic — 3 cloves
  Mon, Tue, Fri
- [ ] Carrot — 1
  Wed
- [ ] Potatoes — 400 g
  Wed, Thu

DAIRY & EGGS

- [ ] Butter — 15 g
  Wed
- [ ] Eggs — 4
  Thu, Fri

FROZEN

- [ ] Sweetcorn — 100 g
  Fri

STORE CUPBOARD

- [ ] Chopped tomatoes — 300 g
  Mon, Tue
- [ ] Beef stock — 150 ml
  Wed

Check the cupboard for: raisins, rice, vegetable oil, green olives, dried brown lentils, small dried pasta, white wine or cider vinegar, tomato purée, worcestershire sauce, olive oil, ground cumin, chilli flakes, dried thyme, smoked paprika.



MONDAY

Cuban-Style Picadillo Beef Hash

8 min prep · 15 min cook · about 880 kcal · serves 1

INGREDIENTS

- 150g beef mince
- 150g chopped tomatoes
- 20g raisins
- ½ onion, diced
- ½ tsp ground cumin
- 70g rice
- 1 tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 handful green olives
- 1 garlic clove, finely chopped

METHOD

1. Cook the rice according to the packet instructions.
2. Fry the onion and beef mince with ½ tsp salt in a splash of oil over medium-high heat for 6–7 minutes, breaking up the mince, until browned with no pink left.
3. Stir in the garlic and cumin for 30 seconds until fragrant, then add the raisins, olives and chopped tomatoes and simmer for 5 minutes until thickened.
4. Taste and adjust the salt, then serve over the rice.

Keep the rest: the beef mince goes into Wednesday's and Friday's dinners; the tin of chopped tomatoes goes into Tuesday's dinner. Wrap it and put it back in the fridge.



TUESDAY

Egyptian-Style Koshari Bowl

8 min prep · 22 min cook · about 630 kcal · serves 1

INGREDIENTS

- 50g dried brown lentils
- 50g rice
- 30g small dried pasta
- 150g chopped tomatoes
- ½ onion, thinly sliced
- ½ tsp ground cumin
- 2 tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 garlic clove, crushed
- 1 tsp white wine or cider vinegar
- pinch chilli flakes

METHOD

1. Simmer the lentils in plenty of salted water for 8 minutes, add the rice and cook for 4 minutes, then add the pasta and cook for a further 8–10 minutes until all are tender. Drain.
2. Meanwhile, fry the onion in the oil over medium heat for 8–10 minutes until deep golden and crisp.
3. Warm the chopped tomatoes with the garlic, cumin, chilli flakes and a pinch of salt in a small pan for 5 minutes, then stir in the vinegar.
4. Taste and add salt, then serve the lentil, rice and pasta mix topped with the sharp tomato sauce and crispy onions.



WEDNESDAY

Speedy Cottage Pie Mash Cup

8 min prep · 24 min cook · about 800 kcal · serves 1

INGREDIENTS

- 180g beef mince
- ½ onion, diced
- 1 carrot, diced
- 1 tbsp tomato puree
- 150ml beef stock
- 250g potato, peeled and cubed
- 15g butter
- 1 tsp Worcestershire sauce
- ½ tsp dried thyme

METHOD

1. Cook the potato in boiling salted water for 15 minutes until tender, then drain and mash with the butter and a splash of milk if you have it.
2. Meanwhile, brown the beef mince with the onion, carrot and ½ tsp salt in a hot pan for 6–8 minutes, breaking it up, until no pink remains and the onion has softened.
3. Stir in the tomato purée and thyme and fry for 1 minute until it darkens, then add the stock and Worcestershire sauce and simmer for 10 minutes until thickened. Taste and add pepper.
4. Heat the grill to high. Spoon the mince into a small ovenproof dish or a large mug, top with the mash and rough up the surface with a fork. Grill for 3–4 minutes until golden and crisp on top.

Keep the rest: the beef mince goes into Friday's dinner. Wrap it and put it back in the fridge.



THURSDAY

Spanish Tortilla-Style Potato & Onion Omelette

8 min prep · 15 min cook · about 500 kcal · serves 1

INGREDIENTS

- 150g potato, thinly sliced
- ½ onion, thinly sliced
- 3 eggs
- 2 tbsp olive oil

METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a small non-stick frying pan and gently fry the potato and onion with a good pinch of salt for 10 minutes, turning occasionally, until tender.
2. Beat the eggs with a pinch of salt and pour over the potatoes, pressing them down evenly.
3. Cook over low heat for 4–5 minutes until mostly set.
4. Place a plate over the pan, flip the tortilla out, then slide it back in to cook for a further 2 minutes on the other side.



FRIDAY

Chilean-Style Beef & Corn Bowl (Pastel-Inspired)

8 min prep · 18 min cook · about 660 kcal · serves 1

INGREDIENTS

- 150g beef mince
- ½ onion, diced
- 100g sweetcorn
- ½ tsp smoked paprika
- 1 egg
- 1 tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 garlic clove, finely chopped

METHOD

1. Fry the onion and beef mince with ½ tsp salt in a splash of oil over medium-high heat for 7 minutes, stirring in the garlic and paprika for the last minute (it burns if fried longer).
2. Meanwhile, boil the egg for 8 minutes, then cool, peel and quarter.
3. Heat the grill to high. Blitz or roughly mash the sweetcorn with a pinch of salt.
4. Season the beef to taste, spoon into a small ovenproof dish, tuck in the egg quarters and spread the corn over the top.
5. Grill for 4–5 minutes until the corn is golden in places, then serve.

Want another week like this?

At solosupper.co.uk there are over 450 recipes written for one, and a free planner that turns any week you choose into one shopping list, added up. Solo Supper Pro goes further and picks low-waste weeks like this one for you, built around what's already in your fridge.

And every Saturday the weekly email brings two dinners that share a pack, with a tip for the planner. You're already on the list.

Plan your next week

Recipes are a guide: ovens vary, so cook meat and fish until it's cooked through. Nutrition figures are worked out from the ingredients and are approximate. Happy cooking, Neil.